Siyu Liang

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Research interests

My research interests are phonetics, computational linguistics, field work, as well as historical linguistics and typology. I'm particularly interested in low-resource speech NLP, language technology, quantitative modeling of speech, etc.

Education

2021 – Present **University of Washington** – Seattle, WA
PhD in Computational Linguistics
Advisors: Professors Gina-Anne Levow & Richard Wright

2017 – 2020 **Georgetown University** – Washington, DC
BA in Linguistics, minors in Persian & Computer Science
Advisor: Professor Elizabeth Zsiga

Presentations

Siyu Liang. 2025 (to appear). De-toning Tibetan Dialects: A Computational Perspective on Tibetan Tonogenesis. In *58th International Conference on Sino-Tibetan Languages and Linguistics (ICSTLL 58)*, Bern, Switzerland. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2025 (to appear). Acoustic correlates of performed sexual orientation in Thai media. In *New Ways of Analysing Variation Asia Pacific (NWAV-AP 8)*, Singapore. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2023. A Phonological Account of Intervocalic Voicing in Yangon Burmese. In *56th International Conference on Sino-Tibetan Languages and Linguistics (ICSTLL 56)*. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2021. Incomplete Vowel Assimilation in Tehrani Persian. In *4th Conference of Central Asian Language and Linguistics (ConCALL-4)*. (Oral presentation)

Siyu Liang. 2019. Documentation of Eynu. In *43rd Annual Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 43).* (Oral presentation)

Publications

Siyu Liang. 2021. Documenting Eynu: A Case Study of Language Contact. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Penn Linguistics Conference.*

Teaching

Winter 2024 LING 572: Advanced Statistical Methods in Natural Language Processing, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant)

Autumn 2023 LING 572: LING 570: Shallow Processing Techniques for Natural Language Processing, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant)

Spring 2022 LING 572: LING 570: LING 200: Introduction to Linguistics, University of Washington (Teaching Assistant)

Industry experience

Summer 2020 **ByteDance (NLP Engineer Intern)** – Beijing, China
Building a FrameNet-based intent framework for large-scale dialog systems. Developing an extendable symbol set for multilingual NLP tasks.

Honors and scholarships

2024 Imre Boba Summer Research Fellowship (University of Washington)

2019 Royden B. Davis Fellowship (Georgetown University)

2018 Lisa J. Raines Fellowship (Georgetown University)

Talks and tutorials

2024 Tibetan Music (Guest lecture)
MELC 269 A: Music Cultures of the Silk Road, Winter 2024, University of Washington

Technical skills

Programming languages
Proficient in: Python.
Familiar with: C++, Java, R.

Software
ELAN, Praat

Natural Languages
Mandarin (proficient), English (proficient), Persian (advanced), French (reading), Thai (intermediate), Tibetan (intermediate), Vietnamese (intermediate), Indonesian (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate), etc.